

MTE 204 – Numerical Methods

Tutorial #4 Solutions

Question 1:

An investigator has reported the data tabulated below for an experiment to determine the growth rate of bacteria k (per day) as a function of oxygen concentration c (mg/L). It is known that such data can be modeled by the following equation:

$$k = \frac{k_{max}c^2}{c_s + c^2}$$

Where c_s and k_{max} are constants.

c	0.5	0.8	1.5	2.5	4
k	1.1	2.4	5.3	7.6	8.9

- Use a transformation to linearize this equation
- Use linear regression to estimate c_s and k_{max}
- Predict the growth rate at $c = 2$ mg/L
- Calculate the coefficient of determination (r^2) and the sum of the squares of the residuals (S_r)

Solution:

Part a:

The equation $k = \frac{k_{max}c^2}{c_s + c^2}$ can be linearized by inverting it to give:

$$\frac{1}{k} = \frac{c_s + c^2}{k_{max}c^2} = \frac{1}{k_{max}} + \frac{c_s}{k_{max}} \frac{1}{c^2}$$

Thus, a plot of $\frac{1}{k}$ versus $\frac{1}{c^2}$ will be linear, with a slope of $\frac{c_s}{k_{max}}$ and an intercept of $\frac{1}{k_{max}}$.

The linearized equation can be expressed as

$$y = a_0 + a_1x$$

Where $y = \frac{1}{k}$, $x = \frac{1}{c^2}$, $a_0 = \frac{1}{k_{max}}$, and $a_1 = \frac{c_s}{k_{max}}$

Part b:

We can use the normal equations and solve them simultaneously to determine the values of a_0 and a_1 , which will allow us to estimate c_s and k_{max} :

$$a_1 = \frac{n \sum x_i y_i - \sum x_i \sum y_i}{n \sum x_i^2 - (\sum x_i)^2}$$

$$a_0 = \bar{y} - a_1 \bar{x}$$

Next, we undertake the computations required to find the values of a_0 and a_1 :

i	c_i	k_i	$x_i = \frac{1}{c_i^2}$	$y_i = \frac{1}{k_i}$	$x_i y_i$	x_i^2	y_i^2
1	0.5	1.1	4.000	0.9091	3.6364	16.0000	0.8264
2	0.8	2.4	1.5625	0.4167	0.6510	2.4414	0.1736
3	1.5	5.3	0.4444	0.1887	0.0839	0.1975	0.0356
4	2.5	7.6	0.1600	0.1316	0.0211	0.0256	0.0173
5	4	8.9	0.0625	0.1124	0.0070	0.0039	0.0126
Σ	9.3	25.3	6.2294	1.7584	4.3993	18.6684	1.0656

$$\sum x_i = 6.2294$$

$$\sum y_i = 1.7584$$

$$\sum x_i y_i = 4.3993$$

$$\sum x_i^2 = 18.6684$$

$$\bar{x} = 6.2294/5 = 1.2459$$

$$\bar{y} = 1.7584/5 = 0.3517$$

$$\sum y_i^2 = 1.0656$$

$$n = 5$$

$$a_1 = \frac{n \sum x_i y_i - \sum x_i \sum y_i}{n \sum x_i^2 - (\sum x_i)^2} = \frac{5(4.3993) - (6.2294 * 1.7584)}{5(18.6684) - (6.2294)^2}$$

$$a_1 = \frac{11.0427}{54.5365} = 0.2024$$

$$a_0 = \bar{y} - a_1 \bar{x} = 0.3517 - (0.2024 * 1.2459) = 0.0995$$

Thus, the mathematical expression for the straight line is

$$y = 0.0995 + 0.2024x$$

We can estimate the values of k_{max} and c_s using:

$$a_0 = \frac{1}{k_{max}} \rightarrow k_{max} = \frac{1}{0.0995} = 10.0502$$

$$a_1 = \frac{c_s}{k_{max}} \rightarrow c_s = (0.2024 * 10.0502) = 2.0342$$

Part c:

To predict the growth rate at $c = 2$ mg/L, we need to find the value of x corresponding to this value of c :

$$x = \frac{1}{c^2} = \frac{1}{2^2} = 0.25$$

$$y = 0.0995 + (0.2024 * 0.25) = 0.1501$$

Then, we can find k using $y = \frac{1}{k}$

$$k = \frac{1}{0.1501} = 6.6622$$

*Note that you can also evaluate for $c = 2$ mg/L directly in

$$k = \frac{k_{max}c^2}{c_s + c^2} = \frac{10.0502 * 2^2}{2.0342 + 2^2} = 6.6622$$

Part d:

First, we calculate the correlation coefficient:

$$r = \frac{n \sum x_i y_i - \sum x_i \sum y_i}{\sqrt{n \sum x_i^2 - (\sum x)^2} \sqrt{n \sum y_i^2 - (\sum y)^2}}$$

$$r = \frac{(5 * 4.3993) - (6.2294 * 1.7584)}{\sqrt{(5 * 18.6684) - 6.2294^2} \sqrt{(5 * 1.0656) - 1.7584^2}}$$

$$r = \frac{11.0427}{7.3848 * 1.4953} = 0.9999$$

Then, the coefficient of determination is

$$r^2 = 0.9999^2 = 0.9998$$

r^2 indicates that 99.98% of the original uncertainty has been explained by the linear model.

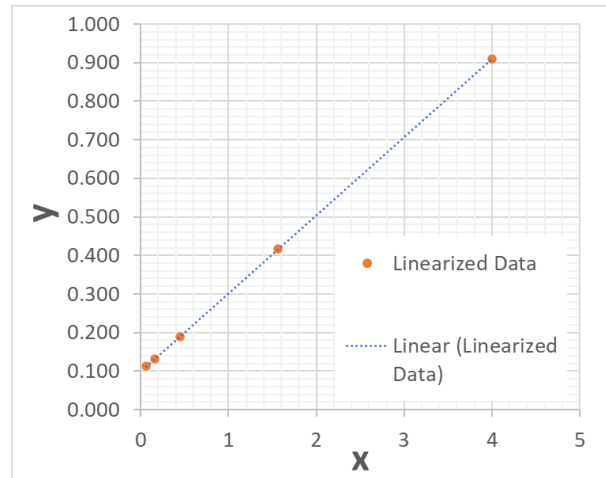
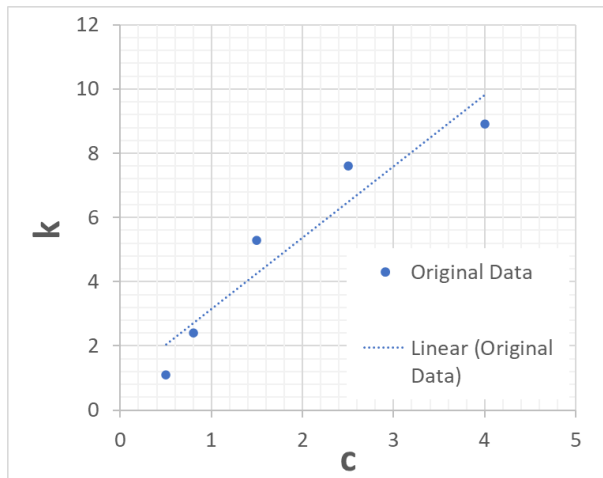
To find the standard error of the estimate, calculate the sum of the squares of the residuals:

i	x_i	y_i	Squares of the residuals $(y_i - a_0 - a_1x_i)^2$
1	4.0000	0.9091	8.26446E-11
2	1.5625	0.4167	8.40278E-07
3	0.4444	0.1887	6.02658E-07
4	0.1600	0.1316	9.30571E-08
5	0.0625	0.1124	4.39114E-08
Σ	6.2294	1.7584	1.58E-6

The sum of the squares of the residuals

$$S_r = 1.58 * 10^{-6}$$

*Note: The linear regression fit can be visualized before and after linearization using excel or MATLAB:



Question 2:

The following data points were measured for an engineering experiment:

x	1.6	2	2.5	3.2
$f(x)$	2	8	14	15

- (a) Develop quadratic splines for the data points and predict $f(2.2)$
- (b) Compare your prediction to the prediction of a first-order spline

Solution:

Part a:

For the present problem, we have four data points and three intervals as shown in the table below.

i	x_i	f_i
1	1.6	2
2	2	8
3	2.5	14
4	3.2	15

The number of conditions required is $(2(n - 1) - 1)$, where n is the number of data points. This means that the number of conditions required is 5.

The polynomial for each interval can be expressed as

$$s_i(x) = a_i + b_i(x - x_i) + c_i(x - x_i)^2$$

Let h define the width of the interval $\rightarrow h_i = x_{i+1} - x_i$

First, the function must pass through all points ($x = x_i \rightarrow h_i = 0$) to satisfy continuity condition:

$$f_i = a_i + b_i h_i + c_i h_i^2 \text{ simplifies to } f_i = a_i \quad \text{Eqn. (18.32)}$$

Second, the function values of the adjacent polynomials must be equal

$$f_i + b_i h_i + c_i h_i^2 = f_{i+1} \quad \text{Eqn. (18.34)}$$

Third, the first derivatives at the interior nodes must be equal:

$$b_i + 2c_i h_i = b_{i+1} \quad \text{Eqn. (18.35)}$$

Forth, assume that the second derivative is zero at the first point

$$2c_1 = 0 \rightarrow c_1 = 0$$

→ Therefore, the conditions required are:

$$f_i + b_i h_i + c_i h_i^2 = f_{i+1} \quad (\text{written for each interval} \rightarrow \text{three conditions})$$

$$f_1 + b_1 h_1 = f_2 \quad (1)$$

$$f_2 + b_2 h_2 + c_2 h_2^2 = f_3 \quad (2)$$

$$f_3 + b_3 h_3 + c_3 h_3^2 = f_4 \quad (3)$$

$$b_i + 2c_i h_i = b_{i+1} \quad (\text{written for the number of intervals minus one, two conditions})$$

$$b_1 = b_2 \quad (4)$$

$$b_2 + 2c_2 h_2 = b_3 \quad (5)$$

Rearrange equations (1) to (5):

$$h_1 b_1 = f_2 - f_1$$

$$h_2 b_2 + h_2^2 c_2 = f_3 - f_2$$

$$h_3 b_3 + h_3^2 c_3 = f_4 - f_3$$

$$b_1 - b_2 = 0$$

$$b_2 + 2h_2 c_2 - b_3 = 0$$

The interval widths are calculated using $h_i = x_{i+1} - x_i$:

i	x_i	f_i	h_i
1	1.6	2	0.4
2	2	8	0.5
3	2.5	14	0.7
4	3.2	15	-

After substituting these values into the conditions:

$$0.4 b_1 = 6$$

$$0.5 b_2 + 0.25 c_2 = 6$$

$$0.7 b_3 + 0.49 c_3 = 1$$

$$b_1 - b_2 = 0$$

$$b_2 + c_2 - b_3 = 0$$

The system has five equations with five unknowns (b_1, b_2, c_2, b_3, c_3), which can be expressed in matrix form. The coefficient matrix [A] can be expressed as

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0.4 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.5 & 0.25 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0.7 & 0.49 \\ 1 & -1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & -1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

The constants vector {B} is

$$\begin{Bmatrix} 6 \\ 6 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{Bmatrix}$$

and the unknowns' vector {x} is

$$\begin{Bmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ c_2 \\ b_3 \\ c_3 \end{Bmatrix}$$

The system can be solved using one of the techniques we learned for solving a system of linear equations (e.g., Gauss-Seidel or Gauss elimination methods):

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0.4 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0.5 & 0.25 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0.7 & 0.49 \\ 1 & -1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & -1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{Bmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ c_2 \\ b_3 \\ c_3 \end{Bmatrix} = \begin{Bmatrix} 6 \\ 6 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{Bmatrix}$$

The roots of the system are:

$$\begin{Bmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \\ c_2 \\ b_3 \\ c_3 \end{Bmatrix} = \begin{Bmatrix} 15 \\ 15 \\ -6 \\ 9 \\ -10.8163 \end{Bmatrix}$$

Now, we can substitute the values for the a's, b's and c's into the quadratic spline function for each interval as follows

$$s_i(x) = a_i + b_i(x - x_i) + c_i(x - x_i)^2$$

Interval (1):

$$s_1(x) = a_1 + b_1(x - x_1) \quad (\text{Recall } c_1 = 0)$$

$$s_1(x) = 2 + 15(x - 1.6)$$

Interval (2):

$$s_2(x) = a_2 + b_2(x - x_2) + c_2(x - x_2)^2$$

$$s_2(x) = 8 + 15(x - 2) - 6(x - 2)^2$$

Interval (3):

$$s_3(x) = a_3 + b_3(x - x_3) + c_3(x - x_3)^2$$

$$s_3(x) = 14 + 9(x - 2.5) - 10.8163(x - 2.5)^2$$

$x = 2.2$ lies in the second interval between $x = 2$ and $x = 2.5$. Therefore, we use the spline function $s_2(x)$ to predict the value at $x = 2.2$:

$$s_2(2.2) = 8 + 15(2.2 - 2) - 6(2.2 - 2)^2 = 8 + 3 - 0.24 = 10.76$$

Note: Quadratic splines have their limitations, such as a) the first interval is represented by a straight line because of the assumption of $c_1 = 0$ and (2) the last interval may swing too high.

Part b:

To evaluate the function at $x = 2.2$ using a first order spline, we can use following equation to estimate the intermediate value between two points ($x_0 = 2$ and $x_1 = 2.5$):

$$f_2(x) = f(x_0) + \frac{f(x_1) - f(x_0)}{x_1 - x_0}(x - x_0)$$

$$f_2(2.2) = 8 + \frac{14 - 8}{2.5 - 2}(2.2 - 2)$$

$$f_2(2.2) = 10.4$$

It is clear that quadratic splines smooth out the abrupt slope change at the data points.

